

The technology that Emile used was similar to the Dictaphone/Ediphone, however, there was one radical difference: instead of using a cylinder, Berliner used a flat recording disc and a stylus that cut a spiral groove while the stylus in the cylinder moved up and down in a vertical cut recording format (known also as the "hill-and-dale" vertical cut) to record the audio.



Gramophone

The main advantage of such a medium was that thousands of records could be inexpensively pressed from just one 'master' record.

The Gramophone soon became a worldwide standard and is in existence even today. Although the wax discs have been replaced by vinyl LP's, this device is a treasure.

All this development was happening in the late 1800's and early 1900's. By 1930, with more technological advances, Wire Recorders became available. However, these were extremely expensive (like all new devices) and were affordable only to the rich and famous.

The Audio Tape

The ubiquitous audio tape made its appearance sometime after Wire Recorders. It soon became the media of choice to record on. Although the audio tape was still in its formative stages, it showed a lot of promise. Open reel to reel was the predominant format since the time of inception to the early '80s when digital audio started to make its appearance.